

ANISHA SAMA

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SUMMARY

UX Designer pursuing an M.S. in Human-Computer Interaction at DePaul University, with 2+ years of hands-on experience across the end-to-end design process, from user research and prototyping to applying GenAI in product and interaction design. Comfortable moving between Figma prototyping, user interviews, usability testing, and tree testing, and turning research into wireframes and interaction flows for consumer-facing products. Looking to bring that research-to-design range to a role designing intuitive, industry-leading experiences.

EXPERIENCE

DePaul University - Graduate Research Assistant - RAISE Lab

Dec 2025 - Present

- Research dark patterns in generative AI systems, examining how LLM interfaces shape user trust, transparency, autonomy, and decision-making for diverse users.
- Conduct product audits and literature synthesis across AI tools, translating findings into interaction design recommendations for clearer prompts, refusal patterns, recovery flows, and autonomy safeguards.
- Designed scenario-based study materials and supported moderated usability/interview sessions; synthesized findings from 6 participants on confidence, context-window awareness, and recovery behavior.
- Managed research operations through Notion task boards, agendas, notes, recruitment materials, and cross-functional coordination with faculty, PhD, and MS researchers.

Indian National Trust for Art and Cultural Heritage (INTACH) - Visual Communication Designer

2022 - 2025

- Led the end-to-end design and launch of a multilingual [Bhavnagar heritage website](#), defining its information architecture, content hierarchy, navigation, and visual design to make Bhavnagar's cultural history accessible to diverse audiences.
- Conducted archival and cultural research and authored articles for [Bhavnagar Heritage Magazine](#), translating complex historical material into clear, engaging stories for a public audience of over 1,400 subscribers.
- Developed content strategies for social media and researched and designed heritage education programs for students, transforming cultural research into age-appropriate content and engaging learning experiences.

The Seven IT Solutions - User Experience Designer

Feb 2021 - Jan 2022

- Designed user flows, wireframes, and interactive prototypes in Figma for client digital products, applying interaction design and user-centered design methods across the end-to-end design process from concept through handoff.
- Collaborated with developers and stakeholders to translate business requirements into visual design solutions, iterating on layouts based on usability feedback.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Podify - UX/UI Product Design Case Study

2026

- Designed 25+ Figma screens for a music/community product, including onboarding, discovery, dashboard, and content interaction flows using components, variants, and Auto Layout.
- Iterated through 3 prototype rounds from 5 user-feedback sessions, improving visual hierarchy, CTA clarity, navigation, and the storytelling arc of the product experience.

Pineapple - Healthcare Access & Scheduling App

2025

- Co-designed a healthcare access and appointment-scheduling experience; created user flows, wireframes, and interactive prototypes for a clearer patient journey.
- Completed 4 moderated usability tests and identified 12+ friction points, then translated findings into revised screens, clearer labels, and simplified task flows.

Tech Careers & AI - UX Research Study

2026

- Co-conducted observation sessions with 9 participants and interviews with 8 participants to understand how early-career job seekers navigate an AI-disrupted tech job market.
- Synthesized findings using the AEIOU framework and affinity diagramming, translating patterns into 2 personas and experience maps representing distinct job-seeker needs, and a priority matrix ranking 8 features by impact and feasibility to guide the design direction.

TaskLight - AI-Powered Productivity Platform

- Designed a centralized dashboard integrating tasks, deadlines, and messages from Outlook, Teams, Slack, and learning-management systems.
- Developed AI-based prioritization to identify urgent action items; translated user needs into sketches, interaction flows, and a high-fidelity Figma prototype.

Google Maps: Smart Journey Notifications - UX Study

2026

- Studied transit scenarios to identify when timely alerts could help users prepare, leave, or adjust their travel plans.
- Designed the "Make the Wait Useful" concept, which recommends nearby cafés, restaurants, or stores during transit delays and uses walking distance, remaining wait time, and a return-time buffer to determine whether the stop fits without risking the trip.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Design: UX Design, Interaction Design, Visual Design, Information Architecture, Wireframing, Prototyping, Design Systems, Accessibility (WCAG), Content Strategy

Research: User Interviews, Moderated Usability Testing, Think-Aloud Protocol, Tree Testing, Card Sorting, Heuristic Evaluation, Affinity Mapping, Thematic Analysis

Tools: Figma, FigJam, Miro, Atlas.ti, Qualtrics, Axure RP, Adobe Photoshop, Adobe Illustrator, Notion, Microsoft Teams, HTML/CSS, Generative AI Prototyping Tools

Strengths: Customer-Centered Storytelling, Design Rationale, Stakeholder Communication, Ambiguity, Responsible AI, Cross-Functional Collaboration

EDUCATION

M.S Human Computer Interaction - DePaul University | **GPA: 3.80/4.0 (June 2027)**

B.E Electronics and Communications Engineering - Gujarat Technological University | **GPA: 8.0/10.0**